looked more like a rock star than a state leader. She tackled a wide range of topics with clarity and fluency. She rightly said, don't focus on the personality, focus on the matter.

6 AI'S GOOD, BAD, UGLY

More than ever, we now need a common set of values so that AI can be programmed correctly. We are literally hard-coding our next reality.

AI allows us to do biology at digital speeds and has squeezed billions of hours of PhD into one year. This is a phenomenal leap for science. Tech regulations need to keep pace with this speed of change. Legislations that take years to formulate are misfits with technologies that change in minutes. We should make AI transparent, accountable and auditable. The first and last touch on AI must be human.

AI also allows the creation of wide-scale automated misinformation, including medical deep fakes and hacking of bio codes. Even without bad intent, AI is prone to hallucinations—making up things that don't exist—which is why it needs to be watched and regulated carefully. We must move ahead with optimistic caution. It is a time to be curious and not judgmental, but also cautious.

There are three big players in AI—the Beijing AI institute, MSN and Open AI, Google and DeepMind. AI gives us the possibility to code a better reality. The worry is that China's version of a better reality may be very different from that of the liberal world.



7 UKRAINE: A SUPERPOWER VERSUS 'SUPERWILL'

You can have weapons and strategy, but the rarest of all things is the will to fight, and that's what Ukrainians have shown.

Every war ends in a negotiation, not a complete win or loss. The faster we can negotiate, the more lives we can save. The question to ask is how much difference will it make if the line where the fighting stops is 100 km this way or that way versus how many people are dying daily? How many lives will be saved if we end the war fast?

8 RE-HUMANISE

A combination of Covid, smartphones and social media has led to an accelerated trend of isolation, especially among teens. Today's youth are desperate for humans. We have to work on rehumanising our young. They need to know and be assured that they don't always have to be their filtered selves in real life.

9 GREENWASH

Greenwash is when companies just tick the box for ESG (environmental, social, and governance) but it's more hogwash than genuine effort. Greenwash is also a comeback by the non-converted who believe the world's being brainwashed by exaggerated perils of climate change.

10 ENGINEERS ARE THE NEW OIL OF INDIA

In its engineers, India has the world's best natural resource for the next level of growth. What oil is to Saudi, engineers are to India, which is what we need to build our next ventures. Look no further than Silicon Valley where Indian engineers are driving change both as CEOs of top tech giants and as founders of startups.

On India's growth, while the West is happy about not having too big a recession, India is unhappy about 6% growth! Perspectives matter from where you are sitting.

11 GURU TO THE WORLD

The mental health industry in the world is a few trillion dollars and India can have a huge guiding role to play by offering its ancient wisdom in yoga and meditation to heal the world. Another type of soft power!

12 LOOKING FOR DARK MATTER

In the pictures taken by the James Webb space telescope, it's not the sparkly things that are important, but the dark matter in between that we need to learn the most about. ■

POST SCRIPT

Ministers at Davos: The Indian contingent comprised four ministers—Ashwini Vaishnaw, Smriti Irani, R.K. Singh and Mansukh Mandaviya. Also present for just a day was Maharashtra Chief Minister Eknath Shinde who rushed back to Mumbai for an event. Raghav Chadha of AAP, looking sharp in his winter gear, had many engagements as a young global leader and played his part to the tee. Also KTR from Telangana, who is a Davos veteran in raising investments for his state.

Vaishnaw was so liked by the European leaders for his views on digital regulation that they wanted to exchange him with their ministers. Irani also came in for ample praise for making compelling points on subjects ranging from gender parity to economy.

Masala chai and hot samosas: The promenade of Davos was dominated by the India contingent. The generous India Lounge served round-the-clock masala chai and hot samosas. Tamil Nadu, Telangana and Maharashtra had state lounges. Tata Tea had a stall handing out free hot tea to those trudging through the snow. Never was a cutting chai more welcome!

Kalli Purie *is Vice Chairperson, India Today Group*